

Esam El-Kholy

Senior Game Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Game Engineer specializing in developer tooling and pipelines — building the engines, editors, and automation that other developers rely on. 5+ years shipping across PC, VR, and console platforms (Meta Quest, Mobile, Switch), with a track record of multiplying team productivity: CI/CD pipelines adopted by 5 projects, reusable engine tooling, and editor tools that measurably cut build and debugging time. Skilled in C# and C++ with deep expertise in Unity3D and game engine architecture, and a passion for mentoring and elevating team workflow.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Skeleton Crew Studio, Senior Game Engineer

02/2021 – Present
Kyoto, Japan

- ▶ Architected and implemented scalable gameplay systems and custom tools across multiple shipped titles, improving development velocity and team workflow.
- ▶ Designed and deployed CI/CD build pipelines adopted by 5 projects, cutting build-and-test time by ~70% and dramatically shortening iteration cycles.
- ▶ Developed in-editor build-trigger tools that let the team launch builds directly from inside Unity, removing manual steps from the release process.
- ▶ Built reusable engine and editor tooling — including a Unity-based visual novel engine adopted by 2 projects and a node-based Yarn Spinner editor that cut debugging and testing time by ~50% (see Projects).
- ▶ Founded an internal learning center consolidating research and findings, enabling knowledge sharing across all teams and projects.
- ▶ Delivered projects across PC, Meta VR, Nintendo Switch, and Mobile.
- ▶ Identified and resolved critical performance bottlenecks and bugs, improving frame rate and stability on constrained platforms.
- ▶ Mentored junior developers, refining their skills and fostering a collaborative, team-focused culture.

SKILLS

Languages: C# (Proficient), C++ (Knowledgeable)

Engines: Unity3D (Proficient), Unreal Engine (Familiar)

Technologies: Photon, Virtual Reality, Yarn Spinner, CI/CD

Platforms: PC, Meta VR/Quest, Switch

Core Concepts: Game Engine Architecture, Computer Graphics, 3D Math

Practices: Editor & Pipeline Tooling, Build Automation, Performance Optimization, Mentoring

PROJECTS

UI Studio, Senior Game Engineer

Internal — Skeleton Crew Studio

A standalone Unity package combining a custom editor tool and a runtime navigation system for authoring uGUI screens, wiring how they connect, and routing between them at play time. Adopted by 3 projects, enabling a working game flow to be built in a single day.

Visual Novel Engine & Node Editor, Senior Game Engineer

Internal — Skeleton Crew Studio

A reusable Unity-based visual novel engine adopted by 2 projects, paired with a visual node-based editor for authoring, visualizing, and debugging Yarn Spinner node connectivity and execution flow — cutting debugging and testing time by ~50%.

Fantasketch ↗, Senior Game Engineer

A puzzle-action game where the characters you draw come to life and move — control your creation and guide it to the goal. Available on Steam.

TwinSoul ↗, Senior Game Engineer

Upcoming music-action game set in mythological Japan. Demo available on Steam.

Death Game Hotel ↗, Senior Game Engineer

An intense VR strategy battle, available on Meta Quest and Steam.

Autoliv ↗, Game Engineer

An interactive product-visualization experience for Autoliv, the world's largest automotive safety supplier.

EDUCATION

Information Technology Institute (ITI)

9-Month Professional Diploma — Game Development Track

10/2017 – 07/2018
Cairo, Egypt

Tanta University — Faculty of Engineering

B.Sc. in Computer Science and Automated Control

10/2009 – 07/2016
Tanta, Egypt

LANGUAGES

Arabic
Native

English
Professional

Japanese
Conversational — strong listening, active in daily meetings